

Music on the move

The personal stereo was the brainchild of **MASARU IBUKA**, chairman of the Japanese electronics company Sony, who wanted to combine a **compact tape recorder** with **lightweight headphones**. The Walkman was launched in 1979. This handy, portable device let users listen to their favorite **CASSETTES** while they were out and about. By 1982, more than 100 million had been sold.



How it changed

The Walkman allowed people to take their choice of tunes wherever they went. Today's MP3 owners can take their entire music collections with them.

the world

Compact choice

As **compact discs** began to replace cassettes in the music market, **Sony** introduced the industry's first portable player for compact discs in 1982. The **DISCMAN** was a success among music lovers, but the device could carry only **one disc** at a time and had a tendency to skip.

Personal stereo

These revolutionary portable devices have ensured that music fans can **STAY TUNED** to the music they love.

Tiny tunes

German inventors **DIETER SEITZER** and **KARLHEINZ BRANDENBURG** came up with a way of compressing digital music so that a music file takes up much less space. Their format is called **MP3** and manufacturers used it to make small digital music players. The first MP3 player became available in 1998. These **groundbreaking gadgets** can store thousands of songs.

